

Stem-and-leaf diagrams

Another way of showing data is in stem-and-leaf diagrams. These give a clearer picture of the way the data is distributed within the range than a simple measure-of-spread diagram.

This is how the data appears before it has been organized.

34, 48, 7, 15, 27, 18, 21, 14, 24, 57, 25,
12, 30, 37, 42, 35, 3, 43, 22, 34, 5, 43,
45, 22, 49, 50, 34, 12, 33, 39, 55

Sort the list of data into numerical order, with the smallest number first. Add a zero in front of any number smaller than 10.

03, 05, 07, 12, 12, 14, 15, 18, 21, 22, 22,
24, 25, 27, 30, 33, 34, 34, 34, 35, 37, 39,
42, 43, 43, 45, 48, 49, 50, 55, 57

To draw a stem-and-leaf diagram, draw a cross with more space to the right of it than the left. Write the data into the cross, with the tens in the “stem” column to the left of the cross, and the ones for each number as the “leaves” on the right hand side. Once each value of tens has been entered into the stem, do not repeat it, but continue to repeat the values entered into the leaves.

this is the stem. 1 stands for 10, 2 for 20, and so on

this is the leaf, which is joined to the stem to form a complete number

